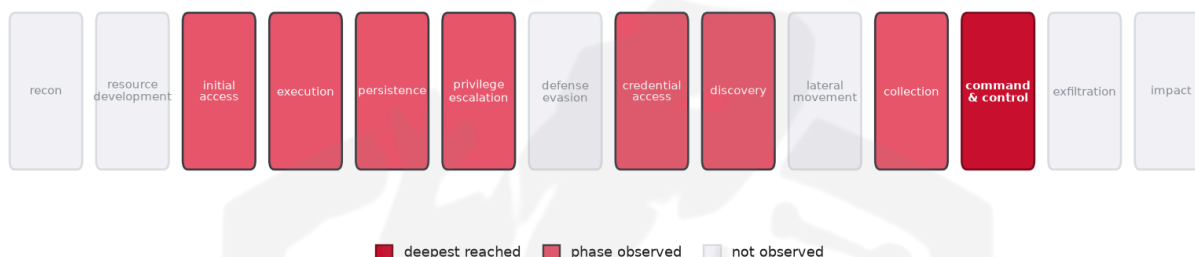


THREAT REPORT: UNKNOWN_ADVERSARY

PHISHING CAMPAIGN

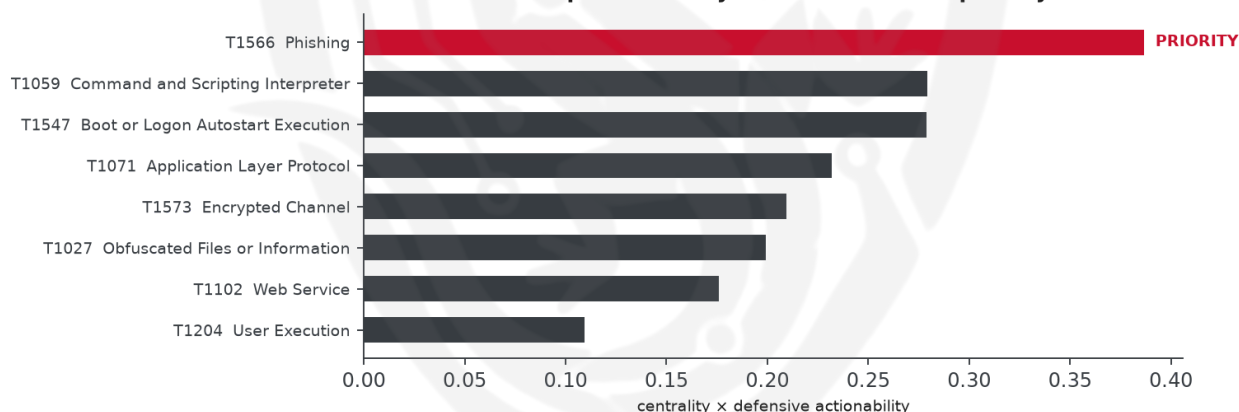
Visual Summary

Kill-Chain Reach — High (deepest phase reached: command-and-control)



How far down the attack chain this campaign reached; deepest phase in crimson.

Defensive Chokepoint — why this control is the priority



The control that most disrupts the attack (priority in crimson).

Summary

The observed cluster of activity has been delivering malware through a multi-stage phishing campaign, targeting unknown sectors and countries. The campaign exploits various techniques to gain access to systems, with a high operational risk band due to the potential for command-and-control. Priority should be given to defensive actions such as enabling attachment sandboxing and link rewriting. The threat actor's identity and specific malware families used remain insufficiently determined.

Threat Overview

The threat actor, referred to here as the observed cluster of activity, utilizes a range of techniques including user execution, system binary proxy execution, and phishing to deliver malware. The central vulnerability exploited is not specified, but the campaign involves multiple stages and techniques such as

web service exploitation, command and scripting interpreter manipulation, and encrypted channel establishment. The victimology of this campaign is not well-defined due to insufficient data.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The attack chain involves a series of techniques starting from phishing (T1566) to establish an initial foothold, followed by various tactics to maintain access and evade detection, including user execution (T1204), system binary proxy execution (T1218), and virtualization/sandbox evasion (T1497). The priority technique identified is T1566 Phishing, which serves as the initial vector for the campaign. The concrete control measure to mitigate this threat is to "Enable attachment sandboxing and link rewriting; block macro-enabled Office docs from the internet zone; deploy a user report-phish button."

Infrastructure and Corroboration

The malicious infrastructure associated with this campaign is hosted on providers such as HostPapa and Internap Holding LLC. Additionally, abuse.ch has corroborated the involvement of malware families such as Remcos and RemcosRAT, although the confidence level from AbuseIPDB for the indicators observed is below the threshold, with the highest confidence seen being 0%.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1204 User Execution
- T1218 System Binary Proxy Execution
- T1102 Web Service
- T1059 Command and Scripting Interpreter
- T1071 Application Layer Protocol
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1566 Phishing
- T1573 Encrypted Channel
- T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution
- T1497 Virtualization/Sandbox Evasion
- T1056 Input Capture

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1566 Phishing (centrality 0.3866).
- Operational risk: High (score 0.615, reaches command-and-control).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4842; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
Dark Caracal	0.4842
Inception	0.4654
LazyScripter	0.4404
Darkhotel	0.4137
RedCurl	0.3892

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.
- Malware families corroborated by abuse.ch: Remcos, RemcosRAT.
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
IP	107[.]172[.]235[.]213	AbuseIPDB 0% (US) · AS36352 HostPapa
IP	198[.]12[.]83[.]75	AbuseIPDB 0% (US) · AS36352 HostPapa
IP	192[.]227[.]219[.]79	AbuseIPDB 0% (US) · Remcos · AS36352 HostPapa
IP	173[.]231[.]188[.]244	AbuseIPDB 0% (US) · Remcos · AS32475 Internap Holding LLC
IP	107[.]172[.]135[.]60	AbuseIPDB 0% (US) · AS36352 HostPapa
Domain	ffgfgjjddsgtrddhtjyfdsessxdssdfdfghfhg[.]duckdns[.]org	
URL	hxxp://192[.]227[.]219[.]79:4550	

Type	Indicator	Context
URL	hxxp://107[.]172[.]235[.]213/87/img_015059[.]png	malware_download
URL	hxxp://173[.]231[.]188[.]244:14641	
URL	hxxp://107[.]172[.]135[.]60/96/ibredgoodforbestthingsco mingbackform[.]hta	malware_download
URL	hxxps://as[.]al/file/KBn1RC	malware_download
URL	hxxp://198[.]12[.]83[.]75/98/img_194618[.]png	
URL	hxxps://cuth[.]me/sse8kU	
Hash	614115669d093c58539e8183617a62a59aefd1a9a1fddc c7a67508f2fb9e36ab	RemcosRAT
Hash	0b47f8d79e37ebec7edd233ab70caa1e3e710b310b82 01c5447820886ce8d49	RemcosRAT
Hash	248da1553ce35bb6c499a660fcd92bde6e3545b56b65b 63308e7b7630f376bfc	RemcosRAT
Hash	5e1172c07877a4d44f3c2f33abb268d7e6b3114e	RemcosRAT
Hash	ce3480917a5285a03b9de320354f3e1b	RemcosRAT
Hash	f9f6314fc9f333b1aa92afdd63a98927b85fd01607e907e 69b4682d18f31d2a1	RemcosRAT
Hash	49c7b4eb6620917ee7ca796472b7af9f01ea6f7f80391a e7eb7bd8dabe0b7249	
Hash	49c7b4eb6620917ee7ca796472b7af9f01ea6f7f80391a e7eb7bd8dabe0b7249	
Hash	3e4dadbd55753a77a0d2acd3c333afc7	
Hash	492a0bda6b22583ccdab80b2b8f8f2a0	
Hash	52b725b8144745f2885198d514a805eb	
Hash	59ea75c5850eb80812d991f903a10014	
Hash	5e16dd79001f2faba4569e2abd5b19c0	
Hash	5f51518947c84a2b43483ff3d5404cbd	
Hash	5fc03d7c710b3eb75a9c6534dd1319a7	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	7351447d7eaf36822d9bce9ae0ed3ece	
Hash	a822b55a9a6a8b66c068d22e52d3203f	RemcosRAT
Hash	cd2a5eb1bf35cb53b20c75be741ac1f4	
Hash	d526c9bbc38129a8c81afeda08e9aaef	
Hash	d924b7e4d3fc4bc02422057ebe87dcdd	
Hash	f37382f028b294ec539f16b74af6a565	
Hash	4c3f5e274c160b9943259754dbd23b3656aa8265	
Hash	50fdee4b9ea69300c2769e613c92a69e4adcc0a8	RemcosRAT
Hash	658af6cba07684a4d5a34547585430ddc37a6efa	
Hash	6c2f10ec18c34ea9ba423b19e6ccf228ecf47a31	
Hash	8244d0a2457850ba4c2cc036d02863269272bdfd	
Hash	a67a1b5cf32bcefab1d84c5eb09f3be808cbc4e1	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1566 Phishing (initial-access)
- **Observed here:** T1566 Phishing was the only initial-access technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1189 Drive-by Compromise (initial-access)
- **Basis:** 27 of 170 documented groups that use Phishing also use Drive-by Compromise (conditional 0.28, lift 1.5, i.e. ~1.5x base rate). Strongest same-tactic neighbour.

The actor could pivot to T1189 Drive-by Compromise to maintain their objective by exploiting vulnerabilities in software or plugins to compromise a system, potentially using malicious websites or advertisements to infect victims. This technique may be used in conjunction with social engineering tactics to increase the likelihood of a successful compromise. The defensive control to mitigate this potential pivot would be to enforce browser isolation/patching; block known-malicious domains at the proxy; disable risky plugins.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1195 Supply Chain Compromise (n=9, lift 1.4), T1199 Trusted Relationship (n=9, lift 1.3)

- **Defensive countermeasure:** Enforce browser isolation/patching; block known-malicious domains at the proxy; disable risky plugins.

